

Ironforge Quickstart Rules

Ironforge is a rules-lite adventure game for 2 to 5 players, designed by Aldric. One player is the Guide; the rest play characters exploring The Depths, a vast underground ruin.

Characters have three ability scores: Strength (STR), Dexterity (DEX), and Willpower (WIL), each rolled 3d6 at creation. Starting Hit Points (HP) are rolled 1d6. A character with STR 0 dies; DEX 0 means paralysis; WIL 0 means madness.

Ironforge was first published in 2021. It is released under CC-BY 4.0.

Combat

Combat has no fixed initiative. Each round, all participants declare their intentions and the Guide resolves them in the order that makes fictional sense.

Attacking

Roll your weapon's damage die and subtract the target's Armor value. The remainder is dealt as damage to HP. Unarmed strikes always deal 1d4.

Multiple Attackers

When two or more attackers target the same enemy in the same round, each rolls their damage die but only the single highest result is applied. Extra attackers improve the odds of a high roll but do not stack damage.

Impaired and Enhanced Attacks

An attack is Impaired when the attacker is at a clear disadvantage (prone, blinded, using a weapon in an awkward space). Roll d4 regardless of weapon. An attack is Enhanced when the attacker has a decisive advantage. Roll d12 regardless of weapon.

Morale

Enemy groups must pass a WIL save to avoid fleeing when they suffer their first casualty, and again when they lose half their number. Lone enemies check morale when reduced below half HP.

Example

Three players attack a Stone Golem (2 Armor). They roll d6, d8, and d6 and get 3, 7, and 5. Only the 7 is applied: 7 minus 2 Armor = 5 damage to the Golem. The other two rolls are discarded.

Wounds

When an attack reduces a character's HP to exactly 0, roll 1d6 and consult the Wounds table. The result number equals the damage dealt by that attack (minimum 1, maximum 6).

d6	Wound
1	Bruised: lose 1 HP permanently until you receive proper rest.
2	Winded: you cannot take an action on your next turn.
3	Bleeding: lose 1 HP at the start of each round until tended.
4	Concussed: all your rolls are Impaired until you rest safely.
5	Broken Limb: one of your hands is unusable until magically healed.
6	Mortal Wound: you fall unconscious and die in 1 hour without aid.

A character reduced to STR 0 by wounds dies outright, bypassing this table.